Travel Policy

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Owner	Head of Finance, NovaTech Solutions Pvt. Ltd. (with Human Resources)
Applicability	All employees on the payroll of NovaTech Solutions Pvt. Ltd. at Bengaluru, Pune, Hyderabad and Gurugram offices
HR Contact	hr-helpdesk@novatech.example, ext. 4000
Travel Desk	travel@novatech.example, ext. 4200
Finance Helpdesk	finance-helpdesk@novatech.example, ext. 4100

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1. Purpose and Scope [ALL EMPLOYEES]

1.1 Purpose

This policy sets out the rules for official travel at NovaTech Solutions Pvt. Ltd. ("NovaTech", "the Company"). It explains how to get approval, what each level is entitled to, how to book, how to claim expenses, and what is not reimbursed. The aim is to let employees travel safely and comfortably for business, while keeping travel costs reasonable and transparent.

1.2 Applicability

- This policy applies to all permanent employees from L1 to L7+.
- Fixed-term employees are covered for the period of their contract.
- Interns and third-party contractors are not covered. Their travel is governed by their agreements and needs written approval from the Department Head.
- Travel for relocation and transfers is covered by the Relocation Policy, not by this policy.

1.3 Definitions

- **Business Travel:** Travel outside the employee's base office city that is approved for Company or client work.
- **Base Office:** The office to which the employee is assigned (Bengaluru, Pune, Hyderabad or Gurugram).
- **Travel Desk:** The Company's team that books tickets and hotels through the approved online booking tool.
- **Per Diem:** A fixed daily amount for meals and small incidental expenses, paid without bills.
- **Lowest Logical Fare (LLF):** The lowest fare available within a 2-hour window before or after the preferred departure time.
- **Billable Travel:** Travel whose cost is charged to a client under the client contract.
- **Claim:** A request in the expense system to be reimbursed for travel expenses.

2. Travel Approval Workflow [ALL EMPLOYEES]

2.1 Basic Rules

1. Every business trip must be approved **before** any booking is made.
2. Employees should first check whether the purpose can be met by a video call. Travel is approved only where in-person presence is needed.
3. No employee can approve their own travel, or the travel of a person who reports to them if they are related to that person.

2.2 Travel Request

The employee raises a **Travel Request** in the HRMS expense module with the following details:

- Purpose of travel and the client or project name.
- Dates, route, mode of travel and hotel nights.
- Estimated cost, including any advance needed.
- Whether the trip is billable to a client.

2.3 Approval Matrix

Type of Travel	Traveller Level	Approvers (in order)
Domestic	L1 to L6	Reporting Manager
Domestic	L7+	Department Head
International	L1 to L6	Reporting Manager, Department Head, Finance Controller
International	L7+	Department Head (or Chief Operating Officer if the traveller is the Department Head), Finance Controller
Travel to a high-risk country (as listed by HR)	All levels	Above approvers, plus Head of HR

2.4 Timelines

- Approvers must respond within **2 working days**. For international travel, each approver has 2 working days.

- If an approver does not act within 3 working days, the request is escalated to the next-level approver. There is no auto-approval.
- An approved request is valid for **30 days** from the date of approval. If travel does not take place within this period, a new request is needed.
- A change of more than 2 days in dates, or a change in the city or the estimated cost of more than 15%, needs fresh approval.

3. Entitlements by Level [ALL EMPLOYEES]

3.1 City Tiers

Tier	Cities
Tier 1	Bengaluru, Mumbai, Delhi NCR (including Gurugram and Noida), Chennai, Kolkata, Hyderabad, Pune
Tier 2	Other state capitals and cities such as Ahmedabad, Jaipur, Kochi, Chandigarh, Lucknow, Coimbatore, Indore, Bhubaneswar
Tier 3	All other locations in India

3.2 Air and Rail Travel

Level	Domestic Flight	International Flight	Train
L1 to L2	Economy (LLF)	Economy (LLF)	AC 3-Tier or AC Chair Car
L3 to L4	Economy (LLF)	Economy (LLF)	AC 2-Tier or AC Chair Car
L5 to L6	Economy. Premium Economy if the flight is longer than 3 hours	Economy. Premium Economy if the flight is longer than 6 hours	AC 2-Tier or Executive Chair Car
L7+	Business class on sectors longer than 2 hours, otherwise Economy	Business class	AC 1st Class or Executive Chair Car

Train travel is expected for journeys with a rail time of under 8 hours. Air travel is allowed for longer journeys, or when it is cheaper than rail after counting the hotel night saved.

3.3 Hotel Cap per Night (Domestic)

The cap includes all taxes and is for a single-occupancy room with breakfast, where the hotel offers it.

Level	Tier 1	Tier 2	Tier 3
L1 to L2	INR 5,000	INR 3,500	INR 2,500
L3 to L4	INR 6,500	INR 4,500	INR 3,200
L5 to L6	INR 9,000	INR 6,000	INR 4,500
L7+	INR 14,000	INR 9,000	INR 6,500

3.4 Domestic Per Diem

Level	Tier 1 (per day)	Tier 2 and Tier 3 (per day)
L1 to L2	INR 800	INR 600
L3 to L4	INR 1,000	INR 750
L5 to L6	INR 1,400	INR 1,000
L7+	INR 2,000	INR 1,500

Rules for per diem:

1. **Full per diem** is paid when the employee is away from the base city for more than 12 hours in a day. **Half per diem** is paid for 6 to 12 hours. No per diem is paid for under 6 hours.
2. If the client or the hotel provides lunch and dinner, the per diem is reduced by 50%. If only breakfast is provided with the hotel, there is no reduction.
3. Per diem covers meals, tips, laundry for trips shorter than 5 days, and small incidental costs. No receipts are needed.

3.5 Local Conveyance

Level	Daily Local Conveyance	Airport / Station Transfer (per leg, cab)
L1 to L2	Actuals up to INR 1,000 per day	Actuals up to INR 1,800
L3 to L4	Actuals up to INR 1,500 per day	Actuals up to INR 1,800
L5 to L6	Actuals up to INR 2,000 per day	Actuals

Level	Daily Local Conveyance	Airport / Station Transfer (per leg, cab)
L7+	Actuals up to INR 3,000 per day	Actuals

- Employees should use app-based cabs, metro or buses where available.
- Own car or two-wheeler for outstation travel needs prior approval. Reimbursement is **INR 9 per km** for a car and **INR 4 per km** for a two-wheeler, with toll and parking on actuals.
- Travel between home and the base office is commuting. It is not reimbursed.

3.6 Base-Office Visits by Fully Remote Employees

Fully remote employees who are required to visit their base office for the **4 working days per quarter** under the Work From Home Policy (NT-HR-POL-007), Section 2.3, are treated as being on business travel. Their flights or train tickets, hotel stay and per diem for those days are reimbursed as per this Section 3. These visits are pre-approved by the Reporting Manager for the whole year and need not be raised as separate requests, but bookings must still be made through the Travel Desk.

4. Domestic and International Travel Rules [ALL EMPLOYEES]

4.1 Comparison

Item	Domestic	International
Eligibility	All employees, including probationers	L3 and above. L1 to L2 only for billable client work, with Department Head and HR approval
Approval	Section 2.3	Section 2.3, plus visa and forex steps in Section 10
Booking lead time	7 days (flight)	21 days (flight)
Maximum trip length	30 days	30 days. Longer stays are treated as a deputation and are decided by HR and Finance
Per diem	INR, Section 3.4	USD, Section 4.2
Insurance	Group Personal Accident	Business Travel Insurance (Section 7)
Advance	Up to INR 50,000	Forex card (Section 10.3)

4.2 International Per Diem and Hotel Cap (USD per day or night)

Level	Region 1 Per Diem	Region 1 Hotel	Region 2 Per Diem	Region 2 Hotel
L1 to L2	USD 60	USD 150	USD 45	USD 110
L3 to L4	USD 75	USD 180	USD 55	USD 130
L5 to L6	USD 100	USD 230	USD 75	USD 170
L7+	USD 140	USD 320	USD 100	USD 240

Region 1: USA, Canada, United Kingdom, Western Europe, Australia, New Zealand, Japan and Singapore. **Region 2:** all other countries. The hotel cap includes taxes. A list of cities with a higher cap on account of exhibitions or events is published by the Travel Desk.

5. Booking Process and Advance Booking Timelines [ALL EMPLOYEES]

5.1 Booking Channel

1. All flights, trains and hotels must be booked through the Travel Desk or the approved online booking tool, after the Travel Request is approved.
2. The booking tool applies the entitlements in Section 3 automatically.
3. Bookings made directly on other websites are reimbursed only in an emergency (such as when the tool is down), with the Reporting Manager's approval and not above the fare the Travel Desk could have booked.

5.2 Advance Booking Timelines

Booking	Minimum Advance Booking
Domestic flight	7 calendar days before travel
International flight	21 calendar days before travel
Train	5 calendar days before travel
Hotel	Along with the ticket, at least 7 days before check-in
Visa-dependent trips	30 calendar days before travel, to allow for visa processing

5.3 Late Bookings

- A late booking is a booking within the timelines above. It needs the **Department Head's** approval, and the Reporting Manager must record the reason.
- If the delay is due to the employee, the fare above the LLF available 7 days earlier is borne by the employee.
- Last-minute client emergencies are an exception. The Department Head's approval is enough, and the fare difference is paid by the Company.

5.4 Fare and Hotel Rules

1. Choose the LLF. A higher fare is allowed only if no seat is available at the LLF within the 2-hour window.
2. Choose refundable or changeable fares only where the dates are likely to change.

3. Hotels must be selected from the Company's approved hotel list where one exists in the city.
4. Lounge access, seat selection, extra baggage and meals on flights are reimbursed only for L5 and above, or when needed for a medical reason.

6. Advances and Settlement [ALL EMPLOYEES]

6.1 Advance Rules

Item	Rule
Eligibility	Confirmed employees. Probationers need Department Head approval.
Amount (domestic)	Up to 80% of the estimated out-of-pocket expenses (per diem, conveyance, other), maximum INR 50,000
Amount (international)	Per diem and conveyance loaded on the forex card (Section 10.3)
Flights and hotels	Booked by the Travel Desk. No advance is given for them.
How to request	In the Travel Request, at least **5 working days** before travel
Payment	Within 3 working days of approval, to the salary account

6.2 Settlement

1. The employee must submit the expense claim within the time limits in Section 8.2. The advance is adjusted against the claim.
2. If the advance is more than the amount claimed, the extra amount must be returned to Finance within **10 working days** of the return from travel.
3. If the advance is not settled within **30 days** of the return, the amount is recovered from the next salary as per the Compensation and Payroll Policy (NT-HR-POL-004), Section 6.
4. No new advance is given to an employee who has an unsettled advance.
5. If the trip is cancelled, the full advance must be returned within 5 working days.

7. Travel Insurance [ALL EMPLOYEES]

7.1 Domestic Travel

Employees on domestic business travel are covered by the Group Personal Accident cover and the Group Term Life cover described in the Insurance Policy (NT-HR-POL-006), Section 6. Group Health Insurance continues to apply.

7.2 International Travel

Every employee on approved international business travel is covered by the Company's Business Travel Insurance. The Travel Desk issues the policy certificate at least 2 working days before departure. The cover is free to the employee.

Cover	Limit
Emergency medical expenses abroad	USD 100,000
Medical evacuation and return of mortal remains	USD 50,000
Loss of checked-in baggage	INR 40,000
Delay of checked-in baggage (more than 6 hours)	INR 5,000
Loss of passport, with cost of replacement	INR 25,000
Trip cancellation or curtailment due to medical emergency or death in the family	Up to INR 1,00,000 of non-refundable costs
Personal liability	USD 50,000
24x7 emergency assistance helpline	1800-000-4150 (toll-free from India). Also on the insurance card.

7.3 Rules

1. For emergency medical treatment abroad on official travel, the Business Travel Insurance is the primary cover. The Group Health cover is secondary, as described in the Insurance Policy (NT-HR-POL-006), Section 13.5.
2. The employee must call the assistance helpline within **24 hours** of any hospitalisation or serious incident abroad.

3. Claims for baggage, passport and cancellation must be reported to the Travel Desk within **30 days** of the return, with documents such as the police report and the airline's property irregularity report.
4. Days added for personal travel are **not** covered (see Section 12).
5. Pre-existing conditions are covered only for emergencies. Employees should carry sufficient medicines for the trip.

8. Expense Claims: Submission, Deadlines and Receipts [ALL EMPLOYEES]

8.1 How to Claim

1. Open the **Expense Claim** in the HRMS and link it to the approved Travel Request.
2. Enter each expense by date and category, and upload the receipts.
3. Declare per diem days. The system calculates the amount.
4. Submit the claim. The Reporting Manager approves it, and Finance verifies it.
5. Finance pays approved claims within **7 working days** of approval, to the salary bank account.

8.2 Submission Deadlines

Situation	Deadline
Domestic trip	Within **10 working days** of return
International trip	Within **15 working days** of return
Late claim	Up to 30 calendar days from return, with the Reporting Manager's written reason
Claim after 30 calendar days	Not payable, unless the Finance Controller approves an exception (see Section 16)
Reporting Manager's approval	Within 3 working days of submission
Finance's query response by the employee	Within 5 working days

8.3 Receipts Required

Expense	Document Needed
Air ticket	E-ticket and boarding pass. Added automatically when booked through the Travel Desk.
Train or bus	E-ticket and PNR or ticket copy
Hotel	Original tax invoice in NovaTech's name with the Company's GSTIN, and payment proof
App-based cab or auto	Ride invoice for each ride of INR 300 or more
Auto or taxi without an app	Self-declaration with date, route and amount, up to INR 300 per trip
Per diem	No receipts
Roaming pack or internet	Bill or receipt
Visa fee and courier	Receipt
Client entertainment	Itemised bill, with the names of the client and the employees present, and prior approval
Any other expense above INR 500	Receipt

8.4 Lost Receipts

For a lost receipt of an expense up to INR 1,000, the employee can submit a self-declaration. The total of such declarations cannot exceed INR 3,000 in a quarter. For higher amounts, the Finance Controller's approval is needed.

8.5 Foreign Currency Claims

Expenses paid in foreign currency are converted at the rate in the forex card statement or credit card statement. For cash expenses, the rate on the date of encashment from the bank or forex dealer is used.

9. Non-Reimbursable Expenses [ALL EMPLOYEES]

9.1 Items Not Reimbursed

The following are the employee's own cost and will not be reimbursed, even if the employee has a receipt:

1. Alcohol, tobacco, minibar items and paid in-room entertainment.
2. Personal grooming, spa, gym, massage and similar services.
3. Fines and penalties, such as traffic challans, parking violations and visa overstay fines.
4. Travel, hotel and meals for spouse, family or friends who accompany the employee.
5. Upgrades to a higher class or a higher room category that the employee chose without approval.
6. Lost or stolen personal items, except as covered by the Business Travel Insurance (Section 7.2).
7. Tips above 10% of the bill, where the per diem does not apply.
8. Laundry for trips shorter than 5 days (covered by the per diem).
9. Personal phone calls, and roaming or data charges above the limit in 9.2.
10. Travel insurance bought on one's own, and costs of personal sightseeing.
11. Expenses without valid receipts where a receipt is required (Section 8.3).
12. Gifts, unless approved in writing by the Department Head for a client.

9.2 Other Reimbursable Items With Limits

Item	Limit
International roaming or data pack	Actuals up to INR 1,500 per trip for L1 to L6. Actuals for L7+.
Laundry (trips of 5 days or more)	Up to INR 500 per week
Client entertainment	Up to INR 2,500 per person per meal, with prior approval
Co-working space or business centre (when needed for work)	Actuals up to INR 1,000 per day
Visa fee, courier and photographs	Actuals (business visa only)

10. International Travel: Visa and Forex [ALL EMPLOYEES]

10.1 Passport and Visa

1. The employee must hold a passport that is valid for at least **6 months** after the planned return date. The Company does not bear the cost of getting a new passport.
2. The Company pays the visa fee, courier and service charges for **business** visas only.

3. The visa request goes to the Travel Desk after the Travel Request is approved. Applications should be made at least **30 days** before travel.
4. Do not buy non-refundable tickets before the visa is approved. If the visa is rejected, the visa fee is still reimbursed, but any non-refundable cost resulting from an early booking made without the Travel Desk's confirmation is borne by the employee.
5. Use only the visa category approved for the trip. Doing paid work under a tourist visa, or on a business visa beyond its permitted activities, is a serious violation of this policy and of immigration law.
6. Employees must follow the entry rules of the destination country, such as vaccination and health declarations.

10.2 Documents to Carry

Carry a copy of the approved Travel Request, the invitation letter or client letter, the insurance certificate, hotel and return ticket details, and the Travel Desk contact number (ext. 4200).

10.3 Forex

- International per diem and local conveyance are loaded on a **prepaid forex card** issued by Finance. Employees must ask for the card at least **5 working days** before travel.
- Cash in foreign currency is not issued, except where the destination does not accept cards, with the Finance Controller's approval.
- The card is used only for official expenses. Personal use must be refunded to the Company within 10 working days.
- Unused balance on the card must be returned to Finance, or the card must be handed back, within **10 working days** of the return. Any unspent per diem is not paid to the employee.
- Expenses must be claimed in the claim form as per Section 8.5.

10.4 Safety

Employees must share the itinerary with their manager and the Travel Desk, save the Indian embassy contact number, and follow travel advisories issued by the Company. HR may cancel or postpone a trip at short notice if the destination becomes unsafe.

11. Cancellation and Rescheduling [ALL EMPLOYEES]

11.1 Rules

1. Inform the Travel Desk and the Reporting Manager **immediately** when a trip is cancelled or the dates change. Cancel hotels at least **24 hours** before check-in to avoid a no-show charge.
2. If the trip is cancelled or changed for a business reason (for example, a client postponement), the Company bears the cancellation or change fees.
3. If the trip is cancelled or changed for a personal reason, the employee bears the fees. Exceptions are a medical emergency with a certificate, or a death in the immediate family.
4. A no-show charge is borne by the employee, unless the Reporting Manager confirms in writing that it was due to a reason beyond the employee's control.
5. Unused airline credits belong to the Company. They must be used for the next official trip, within their validity. The Travel Desk keeps a record of such credits.
6. Cancellation and reschedule fees for domestic flights above INR 3,500 per ticket, or any fee for an international ticket, need the Department Head's approval.

11.2 Disruptions by the Airline or Railway

If a flight is cancelled or delayed by more than 4 hours by the airline, the employee may claim reasonable hotel and meal costs on actuals, up to 1.5 times the applicable hotel cap and per diem. Compensation or refund received from the airline must be passed to the Company.

12. Personal Travel Combined with Business Travel [ALL EMPLOYEES]

12.1 Conditions

1. An employee may add personal days before or after a business trip, with the Reporting Manager's approval, given in the Travel Request.
2. Personal days must be applied for as leave under the Leave Policy (NT-HR-POL-001). Weekends and public holidays in between are not counted as leave when they fall inside a continuous period of Earned Leave.
3. Work done from another city after the business trip is governed by the Work From Home Policy (NT-HR-POL-007), Section 10.

12.2 What the Company Pays

Item	Rule
Airfare	The Company pays the lower of the actual fare and the fare for the direct business itinerary. The employee pays the extra.
Hotel	Only for the business nights
Per diem and conveyance	Only for business days
Insurance	Business Travel Insurance does not cover the personal days
Extra baggage, upgrades and side trips	Employee's cost

12.3 Weekend Stay

A weekend stay between two business days is paid by the Company only if the airfare saved is more than the cost of the extra hotel nights and per diem, and if the saving is at least INR 5,000. The Travel Desk will confirm the saving in writing before the booking.

12.4 Family Members

The cost of a spouse, child or any other person travelling with the employee is not reimbursed. The employee must not use Company-booked tickets, hotel rooms or the forex card for another person.

13. Special Cases and Exceptions [ALL EMPLOYEES]

13.1 Client-Paid Travel

If the client pays for the travel directly or reimburses the cost, the employee must not claim the same cost from NovaTech. The Travel Request must record who pays. A double claim is treated as fraud under Section 14.

13.2 Travel on Weekends and Holidays

Travel time on a weekend or a public holiday does not earn Comp-off. Comp-off is granted only for work of at least 4 hours done at the destination, approved in advance, as per the Leave Policy (NT-HR-POL-001), Section 3.8. Employees are encouraged to schedule travel within working hours.

13.3 Stay With Friends or Relatives

No hotel cost can be claimed when the employee stays with friends or relatives. A fixed allowance of INR 800 per night is paid on a self-declaration. Per diem and local conveyance continue to apply.

13.4 Group Travel

When a team travels together, each employee is entitled only to the entitlements of their own level. A senior employee's class of travel or hotel does not extend to junior colleagues. A senior employee may choose a lower category to travel with the team.

13.5 Illness or Emergency During Travel

An employee who falls ill during a trip must call the insurance helpline (international) or the Group Health TPA (domestic), and inform the manager. Extra hotel nights and changed tickets due to illness are paid by the Company, with a medical certificate. The days are treated as Sick Leave if the employee cannot work. Refer to the Leave Policy (NT-HR-POL-001), Section 6.

13.6 Probationers

Probationers may travel on domestic business trips. International travel for L1 to L2 probationers is not allowed. L3 and above probationers need the Department Head's approval.

13.7 Bandh, Strike or Severe Weather

When a trip is cancelled or shortened by a bandh, strike, or severe weather, the non-refundable costs are borne by the Company. The employee must provide the proof of the event, such as an airline notice.

13.8 Employees on Notice Period

New business travel is not approved for an employee in the notice period, except for a client commitment approved by the Department Head. Any advance or forex card must be settled before the last working day, as per the Separation and Exit Policy (NT-HR-POL-005), Section 4.

14. Fraud, Misuse and Consequences [ALL EMPLOYEES]

14.1 What Counts as Misuse

- Claiming expenses that were not incurred, or inflating the amounts.

- Changing or forging receipts, or submitting the same receipt twice.
- Claiming personal expenses as business expenses.
- Claiming per diem for days not spent on travel.
- Booking tickets or hotels outside the approved channel to get a benefit, such as airline points for personal use in return for higher fares.
- Travelling without approval, or beyond the approved dates for personal reasons.

14.2 Consequences

Violation	First Instance	Repeat Instance
Minor non-compliance, such as a late claim, a missing receipt, or booking outside the tool without approval	Reminder and recovery of the excess amount	Written warning
Claim of personal expenses or inflated amount (up to INR 5,000)	Recovery of the amount and written warning	Disciplinary action
Claim of personal expenses or inflated amount (above INR 5,000)	Recovery, written warning and a ban on advances for 6 months	Disciplinary action up to termination
Forged or altered receipts, fake claims, or double claim from client and Company	Disciplinary action up to termination, and recovery	Termination
Misuse of forex card or Company-booked tickets for personal travel	Recovery and disciplinary action	Termination

14.3 Process

1. Finance will flag suspicious claims during review and informs the HR Business Partner.
2. HR will give the employee a chance to explain in writing within 5 working days.
3. Action is taken as per the Code of Conduct Policy (NT-HR-POL-003), Section 7. Recovery is made from salary or Full and Final settlement as per the Compensation and Payroll Policy (NT-HR-POL-004), Section 6.
4. A manager who approves a claim knowing that it is false is also responsible, and may face disciplinary action.

15. Manager Guidelines for Approving Travel [MANAGER AND HR ONLY]

15.1 Principles

1. Approve travel only when it is necessary. Ask whether a video call can do the job.
2. Check the project or department travel budget before approving. Do not approve travel that would exceed the budget without telling the Department Head.
3. Respond within 2 working days for travel requests and 3 working days for claims.
4. Apply the same standard to all team members. Do not favour employees for preferred routes or travel benefits.
5. Never approve your own claim, or a claim where you are a travel companion who has benefited from the expense.

15.2 Checks Before Approving a Travel Request

Check	What to Look For
Purpose	A clear business reason, client name and meeting plan
Duration	No more nights than needed. Weekend stays have a documented saving.
Class and hotel	Within the entitlements in Section 3
Timing	Booking meets the lead time in Section 5.2
Billable status	Recorded correctly, and the client is not paying separately
Leave	Personal days are applied for as leave

15.3 Checks Before Approving an Expense Claim

1. Match dates and amounts with the approved Travel Request and the tickets.
2. Look for red flags: round figures in every receipt, repeated receipts, cab rides on days of no travel, late-night rides on weekends, hotel invoices not in the Company's name, and per diem claimed for days spent on leave.
3. Reject incomplete claims with a reason, and ask the employee to correct them.
4. If you suspect fraud, do not confront the employee. Send the details to the HR Business Partner and Finance within 2 working days.

15.4 Monitoring

Managers should review team travel spend every quarter against the budget. If the spend of any employee is more than 150% of the team average without a clear reason, discuss it with the HR Business Partner and Finance.

16. Exception Handling and Escalation Matrix [MANAGER AND HR ONLY]

16.1 Approval of Exceptions

No manager can grant an exception on their own authority. Exceptions must be approved as follows and recorded in the HRMS.

Situation	First Level	Second Level	Final Approver
Flight class above entitlement (medical certificate, or no economy seat on a critical trip)	Department Head	Finance Controller	Head of Finance
Hotel above the cap (event, client location, sold-out)	Reporting Manager	Department Head	Finance Controller
Late booking (within the lead time)	Reporting Manager	Department Head	Department Head
Domestic advance above INR 50,000	Department Head	Finance Controller	Finance Controller
International travel for L1 to L2	Department Head	HR Business Partner	Head of Finance
Trip longer than 30 days	Department Head	HR Business Partner and Finance	Head of HR
Travel to a high-risk country	Department Head	Head of HR	Chief Operating Officer
Claim after 30 calendar days of return	Reporting Manager	Finance Controller	Head of Finance
Lost receipts above INR 3,000 in a quarter	Reporting Manager	Finance Controller	Finance Controller
Suspected fraud or misuse	Finance	HR Business Partner	Head of HR

16.2 Escalation Timelines

- Each level must respond within **3 working days**. Urgent travel within 48 hours of departure must be decided on the same day.
- If the case is not resolved within 5 working days, Finance informs the Head of Finance and the Head of HR, who will decide within 3 more working days.

16.3 Audit and Records

- Finance will audit at least **10%** of all claims every month, and **100%** of claims above INR 1,00,000.
- Finance and HR will review exceptions and travel spend every quarter.
- All approvals, exceptions and audit records are kept for **7 years**.

17. Frequently Asked Questions [ALL EMPLOYEES]

Q1. I am an L3 employee. What class of flight can I take for a trip to Delhi? Economy, at the lowest logical fare (see Section 3.2). Premium Economy is only for L5 and above on longer flights.

Q2. What is the maximum hotel rate for an L2 employee in Pune? Pune is a Tier 1 city, so the cap is INR 5,000 per night including taxes (see Section 3.3).

Q3. How many days do I have to submit my claim after a domestic trip? 10 working days from the date of return. For international trips, it is 15 working days (see Section 8.2).

Q4. I lost a taxi receipt of INR 600. Can I still claim? Yes, if the total of lost-receipt declarations is within INR 3,000 for the quarter. A self-declaration can be used only for amounts up to INR 1,000 each time (see Section 8.4).

Q5. My client is paying for my hotel. Can I also claim the hotel from NovaTech? No. A double claim is a fraud. You may claim per diem and conveyance if they are not paid by the client (see Section 13.1).

Q6. Can I extend my business trip to Goa for a weekend? Yes, with your manager's approval and by applying for leave if you stay beyond the weekend. The Company pays only for the business portion, and the extra airfare is yours (see Section 12).

Q7. Will I get Comp-off if I fly on a Sunday for a Monday meeting? No. Travel time does not earn Comp-off. Only 4 or more hours of approved work at the destination does (see Section 13.2).

Q8. How soon before travel must I book an international flight? At least 21 days before. A late booking needs the Department Head's approval (see Sections 5.2 and 5.3).

Q9. I fell ill during my trip to Singapore. What should I do? Call the insurance helpline at 1800-000-4150 within 24 hours of hospitalisation, and inform your manager and the Travel Desk (see Sections 7.2 and 13.5).

Q10. What happens if I don't settle my travel advance? If not settled within 30 days of your return, the amount is recovered from your next salary. You also cannot take a new advance until it is cleared (see Section 6.2).

18. Related Policies [ALL EMPLOYEES]

- Leave Policy (NT-HR-POL-001)
- Attendance and Work Hours Policy (NT-HR-POL-002)
- Code of Conduct Policy (NT-HR-POL-003)
- Compensation and Payroll Policy (NT-HR-POL-004)
- Separation and Exit Policy (NT-HR-POL-005)
- Insurance Policy (NT-HR-POL-006)
- Work From Home Policy (NT-HR-POL-007)
- Information Security Policy (NT-IT-POL-001)

19. Revision History

Version	Date	Description of Change	Author	Approved By
v2024.1	1 April 2024	First issue of the Travel Policy	Finance Policy Team	Head of Finance
v2025.1	1 January 2025	Revised hotel caps by city tier and added international per diem	Finance Policy Team	Head of Finance
v2026.1	1 January 2026	Added forex card rules, Business Travel Insurance limits, base-office visits for fully remote employees, and audit rules	Finance Policy Team	Head of Finance